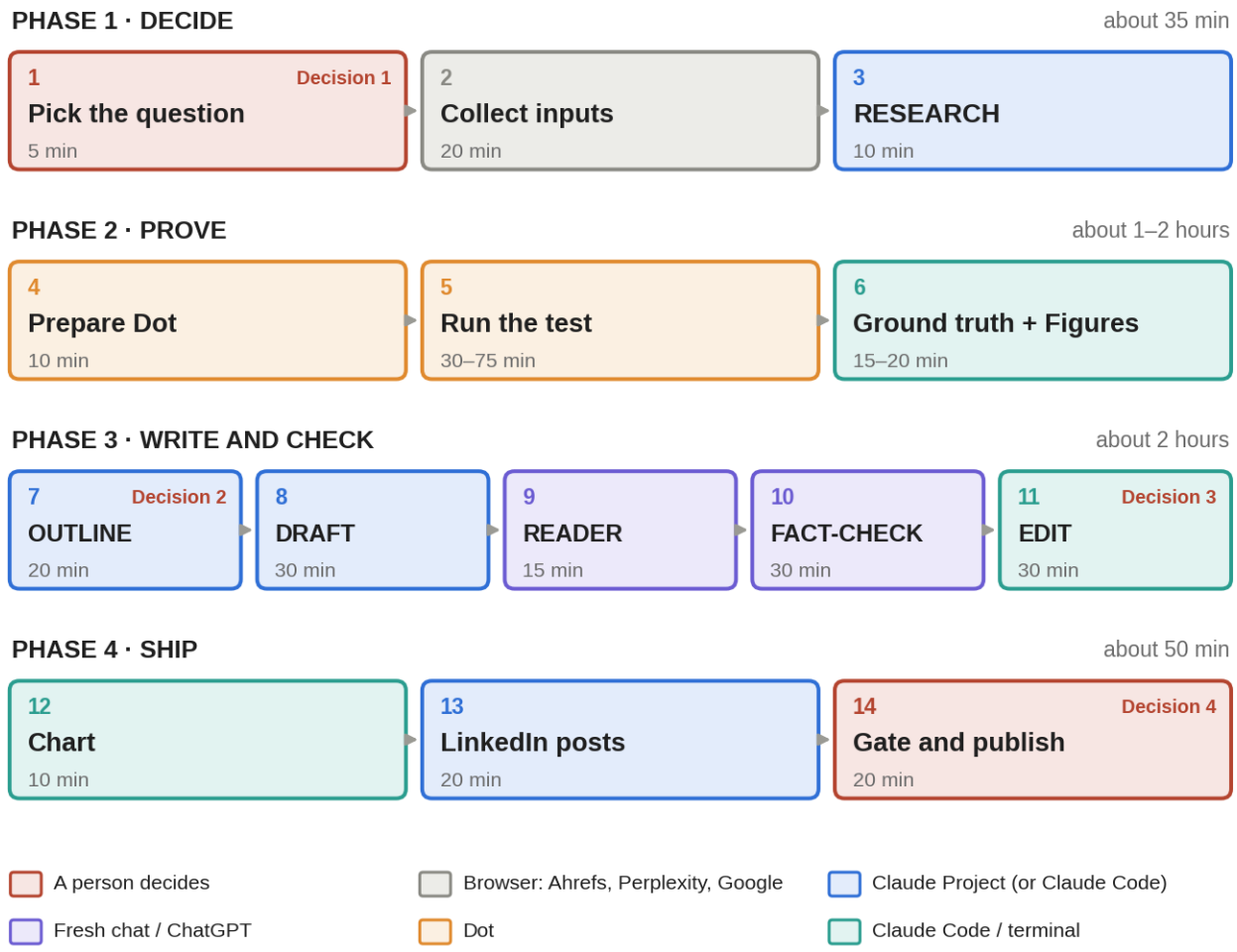
Make a whole piece with the Dot content machine

From a buyer’s question to a finished article, a chart, two LinkedIn posts and a passing checker result, using Dot exactly as the trial did. Fourteen steps, four decisions, about four and a half to five and a half hours of work.



The fourteen steps. Colour shows where each one happens; the four red labels are the decisions only a person makes.

What you’ll have at the end

Output	File
The article, passing 18 of 18 automated checks	pieces/piece-4.md
Every number with its source	figures/piece-4-figures.csv
The chart, with alt text and caption	charts/piece-4-.png and .txt
Two LinkedIn posts, with first comments and tracked links	posts/piece-4-posts.md
Every Dot answer, word for word	runs/piece-4-run.md
The run’s conditions, sources and numbers	The tracking sheet: Run Log, Sources, Figures

How long it takes

Phase	Steps	Time
1 · Decide	1–3	about 35 min
2 · Prove	4–6	about 1–2 hours
3 · Write and check	7–11	about 2 hours
4 · Ship	12–14	about 50 min
One piece		**about 4½–5½ hours of work**

These are estimates from the runbook; nobody has timed a full piece end to end yet. **Write the real time of each step in the Run Log**; after two pieces you'll know the true number. Spread it over two days: Phases 1–2 on day one, Phases 3–4 on day two, so the reviewers read the draft with fresh eyes.

BEFORE YOUR FIRST PIECE · ONCE, ABOUT 30 MINUTES

Set up

Everything the trial used, in your accounts

Set up	How	Check
Claude Project	HANDOVER.md, section 1: paste CLAUDE.md's text into the Instructions box; upload the 12 files to the Files box	Ask "What are the four human decisions?" The answer: the question, the outline, the title, publish
Claude Code (for scripts and files)	Open the dot-content-machine folder in VS Code with Claude Code. Run: pip install pandas matplotlib	Ask it to run python scripts/check_piece.py pieces/piece-1.md → 18 pass, 0 fail
The data, twice	In Dot: the tables you'll test on (the trial used Olist orders and order items). On your computer: the same data as CSV files in data/, for ground truth	Same row counts in both: orders 99,441 and order items 112,650 for Olist
Dot's context notes	The definitions Dot should use. The trial had two active: currency, and metric definitions (revenue and average order value on delivered orders)	List them; you'll log them in every run
The tracking sheet	Your copy of Dot-Content-Tracking (Google Sheets), shared with whoever runs pieces	Six tabs: Question bank, Coverage, Sources, Figures, Baseline, Run Log
The other tools	Ahrefs (Getdot project), Perplexity, ChatGPT; free plans are enough for the last two	Signed in, in one browser
A runs folder	Create a folder called runs in dot-content-machine	Where Dot's answers are kept word for word

STEP 1 · 5 MIN

Pick the question

Where: the tracking sheet

Do this

1. Open the **Question bank** tab.
2. Pick one question. Sales-call questions first; search volume only breaks ties.
3. Give it the next piece number (piece 4, 5…) and set its status to **In progress**.

Save it to	The Question bank tab: Piece and Status columns
Done when	One question, written in the buyer's words

YOUR DECISION

Decision 1: the question. Use the buyer's exact words, not a keyword. If two questions tie, pick the one Dot can prove with its own data.

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

"What does it cost?", from the founders' first sales calls (Q5 in the Question bank).

STEP 2 · 20 MIN

Collect the inputs

Where: Ahrefs, Perplexity, ChatGPT, Google

Do this

1. **Search Console** (Ahrefs → GSC Insights, last 90 days): copy the rows for related queries: query, impressions, clicks, average position.
2. **Keywords Explorer** (Ahrefs, US): enter three to five phrases. Copy query, volume and difficulty, or write "not indexed".
3. **AI answers:** ask the question in Perplexity, ChatGPT and Claude. Copy each whole answer with the engine and date.
4. **Top pages:** Google a short form of the question. Copy the titles and first lines of the top three normal results.
5. Paste everything into one notepad, under four headings: 1 Search Console, 2 Keywords Explorer, 3 AI answers, 4 Top pages.

Done when	Four inputs ready. If one is missing, write "not pulled"; the next step handles it

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

The top pages and AI answers gave list prices and credit bundles: Dupple, Anomaly AI, Actian. Querio's guide recommended measuring cost per correct answer but reported no measurement. Nobody had measured it.

STEP 3 · 10 MIN

RESEARCH: get the verdict and the test plan

Where: the Claude Project, new chat

Do this

1. Open **prompts/01-research.md** and copy the text under "Paste into the Claude Project".
2. Replace each **{paste …}** with the question and the four inputs from Step 2.
3. Start a new chat in the Project, paste it all, and send.
4. Read the five sections. Copy the **Sources rows** into the sheet's Sources tab.

You get	1 The gap chain · 2 The words buyers type · 3 The run: what to test in Dot, on which data, in which mode, which numbers · 4 Sources rows · 5 Stop conditions and the verdict
Save it to	Sources tab; keep the chat open for Step 7
Done when	The verdict is PIECE (or PIECE IF, and you can meet the condition). If it says NOT A PIECE, stop and go back to Step 1

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

Gap: list prices everywhere, no measured cost per correct answer. The run: the same ten questions twice in Dot, reading the credits meter before and after each batch, with ground truth for every answer.

STEP 4 · 10 MIN

Prepare Dot

Where: Dot

Do this

1. Open Dot in the **Production** environment, on the data the run names.
2. Check which **context notes** are active, and write their names down.
3. Open **Settings** → **Billing** and note **credits used** (not the balance). This is “credits before”.
4. Open a new chat and set the **mode** the run asks for (Economy or Balanced). **Screenshot the mode selector.**
5. Add a **Run Log** row now: date, the run’s name, account, environment, mode, active context notes, credits before.

Done when	A Run Log row with the conditions filled in, before the first question

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

Run Log: Production, 2 notes active (currency; metric definitions), credits used 61.9 before batch 1.

STEP 5 · 30–75 MIN

Run the test in Dot

Where: Dot, one fresh chat per question

Do this

1. Ask each test question from Step 3 in its **own new chat**, in the buyer’s words. Don’t rephrase to help Dot.
2. **Before every question, check the mode** still says what the run needs. It can switch by itself.
3. Copy each answer **word for word** into runs/piece-4-run.md, under the question, with the time. Screenshot any answer you may quote.
4. Note what each answer did: answered, asked back, or refused, and whether it **stated its basis** (population, period, definition).
5. After the last question, read **credits used** again. Fill in “credits after” and the result in the Run Log.

Save it to	runs/piece-4-run.md (answers) · the Run Log (conditions, credits, result)
Done when	Every question asked once, every answer saved word for word, credits read before and after

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

Batch 1, 01:45–01:52: the mode switched from Economy to Balanced after question 1; that was found from the screenshots and logged, not hidden. Credits 61.9 → 67.2 = 5.3. Batch 2, all Economy, checked per question: 67.2 → 73.0 = 5.8. Both batches 10 of 10 correct.

STEP 6 · 15–20 MIN

Ground truth and the Figures file

Where: Claude Code

Do this

1. Work out the **correct answer** to every test question from the raw data: in Claude Code, paste the text under **Paste** below, with your questions and definitions filled in.
2. Compare each Dot answer with the correct answer **under the definition Dot stated**. Mark it correct or not, and classify any gap as rounding or real.
3. Create **figures/piece-4-figures.csv** with this header line: **id,value,description,where_computed,date**. Add one row for every number that may appear in the piece: credits, counts, values, percentages.
4. Copy the rows into the sheet's Figures tab.

Paste

```
Using data/olist_orders_dataset.csv and data/olist_order_items_dataset.csv, compute the correct
answer to each question below, under the definition stated after it. Save the code as
scripts/ground_truth_piece4.py and print each value.

1. [question] - definition: [e.g. delivered orders only, price excluding freight]
2. ...
```

Save it to	figures/piece-4-figures.csv · scripts/ground_truth_piece4.py · the Figures tab
Done when	Every number has a row; every Dot answer is marked against ground truth

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

All 20 answers matched the raw data. Rows like: C03, 61.9, Credits used before batch 1, Billing page screenshot 01:44, 2026-10-28. (scripts/ground_truth.py only recomputes piece 1's 20 evaluation answers; a new piece needs its own script, as above.)

STEP 7 · 20 MIN

OUTLINE

Where: the Claude Project, same chat as Step 3 or a new one

Do this

1. Open **prompts/02-outline.md** and copy the paste section.
2. Paste it with three inputs below it: the RESEARCH output, your **figures CSV rows**, and the **Run Log rows** for this run.
3. Read the outline. Check the **Missing figures** list: any number there must get a Figures row, or leave the piece.

You get	Three title candidates (one recommended) · SEO title, meta, slug · the opening in full · the surprising detail · the pocket guide · three H2 claims with their Figures IDs · the table and chart · caveats · Where Dot fits · the instruction · five internal and three reverse links
Done when	You've approved the outline

YOUR DECISION

Decision 2: the outline. Approve it only if every H2 claim has Figures IDs under it and the opening promises what the reader gets. Ask for changes in the same chat until it does.

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

Recommended title: “What an AI Data Analyst Costs Per Correct Answer: Copy This Two-Batch Test”. SEO title: “AI Data Analyst Cost Per Question: What 20 Answers Cost”.

STEP 8 · 30 MIN

DRAFT

Where: the Claude Project, or Claude Code to save the file directly

Do this

1. Open **prompts/03-draft.md**, copy the paste section, and replace **{paste}** with the approved outline.
2. Send. The draft comes back as markdown with its front matter (title, seo_title, meta, slug, queries, figures, reverse_links).
3. Save it as **pieces/piece-4.md**. In VS Code: Ctrl + N, paste, Ctrl + S. Or ask Claude Code to run the prompt and save the file.
4. Check the front matter line reads **figures: figures/piece-4-figures.csv**.

Save it to	pieces/piece-4.md
Done when	900–1,300 words, written as “we” (Dot), every number from the Figures file

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

The bold opening: “Ask an AI data analyst what one answer costs and you get a credit bundle, not a number. We ran ten questions twice in Dot and read the credit meter… By the end, you will have the ten questions and a way to measure your own cost per correct answer.”

STEP 9 · 15 MIN

READER

Where: a fresh claude.ai chat, outside the Project

Do this

1. Start a chat **outside** the Project, so the reader doesn’t know the rules or the plan.
2. Paste the text from **prompts/04-reader.md**, with the whole draft in place of {paste the draft}.
3. Fix all three stopping points in pieces/piece-4.md. If it couldn’t say what it gets after 60 words, rewrite the opening.
4. Log each fix in the Run Log with its cause.

You get	Three places a Head of Data would stop reading · the sentence they’d quote · the claim they don’t believe · whether the opening makes a promise
Done when	All three stops fixed and logged

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

The reader didn’t believe a per-answer cost for Balanced worked out from a mixed batch. It was right: ten different questions aren’t equal units. The estimate was dropped and the batches compared on totals only.

STEP 10 · 30 MIN

FACT-CHECK

Where: a fresh claude.ai chat, then ChatGPT, then Claude Code

Do this

1. **Pass 1:** a new chat outside the Project. Paste the Pass 1 text from **prompts/05-fact-check.md** with the draft.
2. **Pass 2:** the same text and draft in **ChatGPT**. A different model catches different things.
3. **Links:** in Claude Code, run **python scripts/verify_sources.py pieces/piece-4.md**. If it can't reach a site, open each link in your browser.
4. Triage every item: fix it, or write one line on why it stands. Check fixes against runs/piece-4-run.md and the Figures file, not memory. Log every fix.

You get	Numbered lists of problems: numbers and arithmetic, product claims marked VERIFIABLE or ASSERTED, conclusions that go too far, quotes
Done when	Every item fixed or answered; every link opens

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

Fixed after the checks: "credit balance" became "credits used" (Billing counts credits used), and "two of twenty" scoped answers became "four of twenty", after both batches were recounted.

STEP 11 · 30 MIN

EDIT

Where: Claude Code, a colleague, Perplexity and Claude

Do this

1. **The checker:** run **python scripts/check_piece.py pieces/piece-4.md**. Fix every FAIL and run it again, until 0 fail.
2. **The headline test:** show a colleague the title and first 60 words for three seconds. Can they say who it's for, what they get, and why to trust it?
3. **The lift test:** paste the piece into Perplexity, and separately into a fresh Claude chat, with the line below on top. Rewrite any line they misread or skip.
4. Pick the title.

Paste

```
Summarise this article in exactly three bullet points. Each bullet must contain one direct
quotation from the article, in quotation marks.
```

You get	18 pass, 0 fail, 6 for a human · the headline verdict · the three lines AI engines quote
Done when	0 FAIL; the engines quote the lines you intended, and get the finding right

YOUR DECISION

Decision 3: the title. Pick from the three candidates. It must use the words buyers type and promise what the reader gets.

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

All three trial pieces: 18 pass, 0 fail. On piece 2, Perplexity called Dot's clarifying questions its "main weakness"; the heading was rewritten to "The three pauses were questions with two right answers", and both engines then read it correctly.

STEP 12 · 10 MIN

The chart

Where: Claude Code

Do this

1. Copy an existing spec, e.g. **charts/piece-3-cost-by-mode.json**, to **charts/piece-4-<name>.json**.
2. Change its title, data rows, alt text and caption. Every value must be in the Figures file; the caption carries the date and mode.
3. Run **python scripts/charts.py charts/piece-4-<name>.json**. It writes the PNG and a .txt with the alt text and caption.
4. Put the image, alt text and caption into the piece, after the table.

Save it to	charts/piece-4-.png, .json and .txt
Done when	The chart is in the piece with alt text and a dated caption; the checker still passes

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

A ranking chart with two bars: 5.8 credits (all Economy, highlighted) and 5.3 credits (9 of 10 Balanced), titled "Same ten questions: the all-Economy batch didn't use fewer credits".

STEP 13 · 20 MIN

Two LinkedIn posts

Where: the Claude Project

Do this

1. Open **prompts/07-linkedin.md**. Choose an opening structure for the post, one not used in the last few posts.
2. Paste the prompt with the structure filled in and the finished piece below it. Send.
3. Repeat for the second post with a **different** structure, and post-id b instead of a in the link.
4. Save both, with their first comments and images, in **posts/piece-4-posts.md**.

You get	Three first lines tried · the post (under 150 words, names Dot) · the first comment with the tracked link · the image
Save it to	posts/piece-4-posts.md
Done when	Two posts, two different openings, each under 150 words, each link carrying its utm_content

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

Post E, arithmetic first: "5.8 credits, ten correct answers: about 0.58 credits per correct answer." Post F, the list: "Before you compare two AI analysts on price, check four things."

STEP 14 · 20 MIN

The gate, and publish

Where: you, Webflow, Ahrefs

Do this

1. Run the checker one last time: **18 pass, 0 fail**.
2. Do the six human checks: the voice is “we” everywhere, **including the title, meta and chart caption** (14) · every finding is from this run (16) · the dataset and licence are in Sources (18) · READER done (22) · lift test done (23) · read the piece aloud once on a phone (24).
3. Publish in Webflow with the slug from the front matter. Add the chart and its alt text.
4. Ask for the three reverse links listed in the front matter. Add the piece’s target queries to Ahrefs Rank Tracker (US and Germany).
5. Set the piece’s status to **Published** in the Question bank, with the date. Schedule the two posts.

Done when Live, tracked, and logged

YOUR DECISION

Decision 4: publish. Only when all 24 checks pass. If a claim about Dot is still labelled “Assumption”, decide whether it can go out labelled, or must be confirmed first.

HOW IT WENT IN THE TRIAL, 27–28 OCTOBER 2026

The three trial pieces pass every automated check. They aren’t published yet: the phone reads are open, and piece 1’s evaluation is to be re-run on Dot’s own data first.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

The problems the trial actually hit

Each became a rule; here’s what to do

Problem	What to do
Dot’s mode switched mid-run	Check the mode before every question, not just the first. If it switched, log it; never mix modes in one batch you’ll compare
Credits read only once	Read credits used before and after every batch, or cost per batch can’t be worked out
The checker fails a number	It has no Figures row. Add the row with its source, or remove the number
The checker fails an assumption	A sentence mentions an assumed feature without the word “Assumption”. Label it or cut it
A quote doesn’t match	Take quotes word for word from runs/piece-4-run.md, never from memory
Counts done by eye	Count from the text itself. In the trial, eight of sixteen citation counts done by eye were wrong
“I” appears in the title or meta	Rick’s voice: “we” means Dot. Check the front matter and chart captions too, not just the article
The same mistake twice	Add a rule to CLAUDE.md with the date and cause, re-paste it into the Instructions box

One habit matters most: write down the real time each step took. The time per piece is the one number the trial never measured.